

6.1 NATURE OF COURSEWORK



C1.1-1.3; C2.1-2.3; N1.1-1.3; N2.3; IT1.1-1.2; IT2.1-2.3; WO1.1-1.3; WO2.1-2.3; LP1.1-1.3; LP2.1-2.3; PS1.1-1.3; PS2.1-PS2.3.

The internally assessed task involves a simple investigation which allows the candidate the opportunity to put into practice some of the methodological issues which underpin the course. The subject for the investigation may be taken from any part of the Specification Content (Sub-section 5) but all investigations must be based upon psychological principles and literature, and be carried out in accordance with the ethical guidelines in Appendix B. The task set should be appropriate to the ability of the candidate. Some exemplar coursework tasks (Sub-section 6.2) and a mark scheme (Sub-section 7.3) have been provided.

Centres with candidates who do not choose a title from the list given in the specification, may submit to OCR a written outline of the proposed investigation. Proposals will be considered by a Coursework Consultant and replies about their suitability sent to Centres. Investigations must be designed with an awareness of health and safety regulations and must be ethical.

Centres are responsible for ensuring that the ethical guidelines laid down by the British Psychological Society are adhered to and are responsible for ensuring that students carry out research in a safe environment. Students should, as far as possible, collect data within their own school or college, after obtaining permission from the tutor and Head. BPS ethical guidelines state that participants should not be under sixteen. This must be adhered to except in circumstances when the student would have to carry out research outside the school premises in order to comply, as this could have safety implications. You are advised to refer to Appendix B.

The internally assessed task should allow the candidate to:

- develop a research question;
- choose an appropriate method;
- define and operationalise variables;
- develop hypotheses;
- carry out the investigation;
- collect and evaluate data and come to an appropriate conclusion.

To facilitate the collection of data, groups of candidates may work together but all analysis, interpretation and presentation of the work must be completed on an individual basis.

The Investigation must be presented in the standard format of a psychological report. It should be no more than 1 500 words in length. This limit does not include references, appendices and tables. Candidates are required to state the number of words used on the front of the work. Notes for candidates on writing up an investigation are given in Appendix C.